

Past Simple & Present Perfect

Past Simple a) Formation

i) Positive Statements

regular verbs = **verb+ed**
 irregular verbs = to be learnt from the list of irregulars

Example:

I	worked	We	worked
You	worked	You	worked
He/she/it	worked	They	worked

ii) Questions

the past of **to do (did)** + verb infinitive

Example:

Did	I	work?	Did	we	work?
Did	you	work?	Did	you	work?
Did	he/she/it	work?	Did	they	work?

iii) Negative Statements

the past of **to do (did)** +not + verb infinitive

Example:

I did not	work.	We did not	work.
You did not	work.	You did not	work.
He did not	work.	They did not	work.

Often shortened to **didn't**

iv) Uses

to describe a finished action in the past & used with the following signal or trigger words:

yesterday, when, in 1999, last week, (or year or month), in the past, ago,

v) Examples

I **cooked** dinner yesterday for 20 people.

Did you start work last time at 8 o'clock?

We didn't go to see the film after all.

When I was a child, I **went** to a great junior school.

Present Perfect a) Formation**i) Positive Statements**

regular verbs = Auxiliary verb **to have** + **past participle** verb
 irregular verbs = to have + pp from irregulars list

Example:

I	have worked	We	have worked
You	have worked	You	have worked
He/she/it	has worked	They	have worked

ii) Questions

change of word order to have + subject + past participle

Example:

Have I	worked?	Have we	worked?
Have you	worked?	Have you	worked?
Has he/she/it	worked?	Have they	worked?

iii) Negative Statements

to have + not + past participle

Example:

I have not	worked	We have not	worked.
You have not	worked.	You have not	worked.
He has not	worked.	They have not	worked.

Often shortened to **hasn't** or **haven't**

iv) Uses

to describe an action which started in the past and still has an effect up to today;
 often known as a bridge between the past and the present. Used with the following
 signal or trigger words:

**today, recently, over the last 10 years, up to now, this week/month/year, just,
 already, ever, yet, so far**

v) Examples

I have just **cooked** dinner for 20 people.
Have you started to work for the new company yet?
We still haven't been to see the new film.
I have been to 20 different countries so far.

Grammar Exercises

Fill in the past simple or the present perfect:

1. I _____ just bought _____ (just/buy) a new computer. I
_____ bought _____ (buy) the old one 10 years ago, but I now need a
new one which is quicker.
2. We _____ went _____ (go) to International Trade Fair last
year, but I am not sure where we are going this year. We
_____ haven't made _____ (not/make) up our mind yet.
3. She _____ has only ever worked _____ (only/ever/work) for one employer;
she _____ trained _____ (train) in the local bank and
_____ stayed _____ (stay) on there after her banking apprenticeship. She
_____ was _____ (be) the Deputy Manager for the last 8 years.
4. In 1998 Mr. Jones _____ has begun _____ (begin) working as a
self-employed insurance agent, but five years later he _____ went _____
(move) to a big insurance company as area manager.
5. 6 months ago David _____ went _____ (go) into
retirement and since then he _____ has been _____ (be) travelling
Europe.
6. _____ Have you ever thought _____ (you/ever/think) about going to
India?

7. Did you go _____ (you/go) to the sales conference last week? Was it _____ (it/be) good?

8. We _____ have not had _____ (not/have) a holiday for the past 5 years. When we _____ had _____ (have) our children, we simply _____ did not have _____ (not/have) the money or the energy to travel abroad.

9. Over the past 6 months, the sales level _____ have fallen _____ (fall) by over 20%. When the recession _____ started _____ (start), many people _____ did not have _____ (not have) enough money to buy the goods. The situation _____ had _____ (have) a big impact on our company.

10. In the past, customers _____ payed _____ (pay) their bills on time. However, over the last 10 years, we _____ have seen _____ (see) a change in behaviour. Unfortunately, many customers do not pay the invoices on time, so we _____ now introduced _____ (now introduce) a system of paying a deposit in advance.

11. Last year, the company _____ made _____ (make) a loss of \$1.6 million. Since then, however, we _____ have restructured _____ (restructure) the production department and the company _____ have managed _____ (manage) to save a lot of money.